Listing 3.3 implements this check as a filter that is called before every API call. First you check if there is an Authorization header in the request, with the Basic authentication scheme. Then, if it is present, you can extract and decode the Base64-encoded credentials. Then validate the username as always and look up the user from the database. Finally, we use the Scrypt library to check if the supplied password matches the hash stored for the user in the database. If authentication succeeds then you store the username in an attribute on the request so that other handlers can see it, otherwise you leave it as null to indicate an unauthenticated user. Open the UserController.java file that you previously created and add the authenticate method as given in the listing.

Listing 3.3 Authenticating a request

```
public void authenticate(Request request, Response response)
{
  var authHeader = request.headers("Authorization");    #A
  if (authHeader == null || !authHeader.startsWith("Basic "))
{
    return;
  }

  var offset = "Basic ".length();
  var credentials = new String(Base64.getDecoder().decode(
#B
      authHeader.substring(offset)), StandardCharsets.UTF_8);

  var components = credentials.split(":", 2);    #C
  if (components.length != 2) {
    throw new IllegalArgumentException("invalid auth
header");
  }
```